BRAND PLAN & 3-YEAR ROADMAP

ProteinPeak — FY27 Brand Plan & 3-Year Growth Roadmap

Acme's growth engine in the category's fastest-growing pocket

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Document type Internal brand plan (3-year)
Period FY27 plan · FY27–FY29 roadmap
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Trajectory	**$48M FY25 → $80M FY26 plan → ~$110M FY28 / ~$140M FY29 (targets)**
Category	**Wellness Protein +18.3% ($840M); Acme share 7.6→8.4%**
Launch read (Apr 20)	**Trial 110% plan at Target vs 77% Walmart-pilot**
Source of volume	**53% new-to-brand · 32% cannibalization · 15% switch**
Q2 FY26 vs plan (post-launch)	**$10.9M vs $11.6M plan · -6.1%**

Executive summary

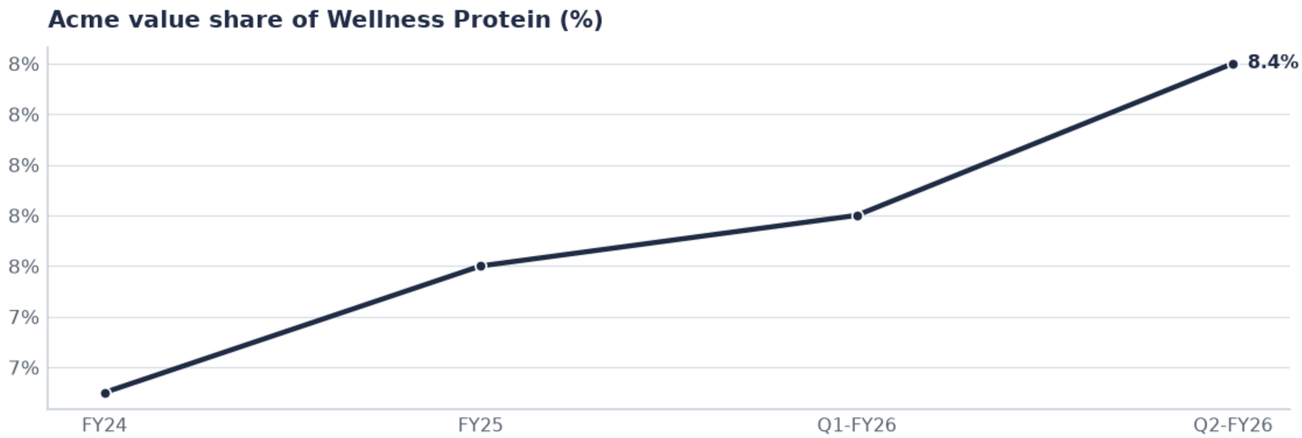
ProteinPeak is Acme's growth engine, and it is pointed at the right target. Wellness Protein is the fastest-growing pocket in RTE cereal — +18.3% in FY25 to $840M — and Acme's share is climbing (7.6% FY25 to 8.4% Q2-FY26 MTD) on the back of the April 20 Cinnamon Crunch (PP005) and Cocoa Almond (PP006) launch. The launch read is strong where it matters: trial at 110%+ of plan at Target, a healthy 53% new-to-brand source of volume, W2 repeat ~1.2x the Berry Crunch benchmark, and the best social sentiment in the portfolio (+0.44). The three-year plan builds from $80M FY26 to planning targets of ~$110M FY28 and ~$140M FY29 — a roadmap of Target-first distribution expansion, a validated Chocolate Almond gate-pass for Q3, and a form-factor pipeline (Mini Cups, Bars). The principal threat is Larksfield's Field & Honey 14g protein extension.

- **Right category, gaining share.** Wellness Protein +18.3% to $840M; Acme share 7.6% → 8.4% (Q2-FY26 MTD). This is where the portfolio grows (seed_category_market_size).
- **Launch is working.** Trial 110%+ of plan at Target vs 77% Walmart-pilot; 53% of volume is new-to-brand; W2 repeat ~1.2x Berry Crunch; sentiment +0.44 on ~496 mentions.
- **Target over-indexes hard.** Acme Wellness Protein share is 18.4% at Target vs 5.2% at Walmart — the roadmap is Target-anchored and channels-out.
- **Pipeline is gated and real.** Chocolate Almond cleared the concept-test gate (64% top-2-box vs 55% standard; 8pp substitutional < 12pp SteerCo gate) for a Q3 launch; Mini Cups (2027-Q4) and Bars 12g (2028) extend form factors.
- **The threat:** Field & Honey 14g protein (LCH00032, May 12) narrows our protein delta from 11g to 6g — we defend on sugar, cinnamon and repeat, not on grams.

1 · The category — and why ProteinPeak wins by playing here

WELLNESS PROTEIN $	ACME SHARE	TARGET SHARE	SOCIAL SENTIMENT
$840M	8.4%	18.4%	+0.44
FY25, +18.3%	Q2-FY26 (was 7.6%)	vs 5.2% Walmart	best in portfolio

Wellness Protein is the single best place to be in RTE cereal. It grew +18.3% in FY25 to $840M — an order of magnitude faster than Family Sweet (+1.4%) or the total category (+1.3%) — and the high-protein-cereal macro trend reads 0.92, the strongest signal Acme tracks. ProteinPeak is not just riding the category; it is taking share within it: Acme's Wellness Protein value share moved from 7.1% (FY24) to 7.6% (FY25) to 8.4% (Q2-FY26 MTD). The strategic implication is that a dollar of ProteinPeak investment compounds twice — category growth plus share gain — which is precisely why it earns the portfolio's discretionary innovation spend (cross-ref the LRP, Report 15, and the innovation portfolio, Report 33).

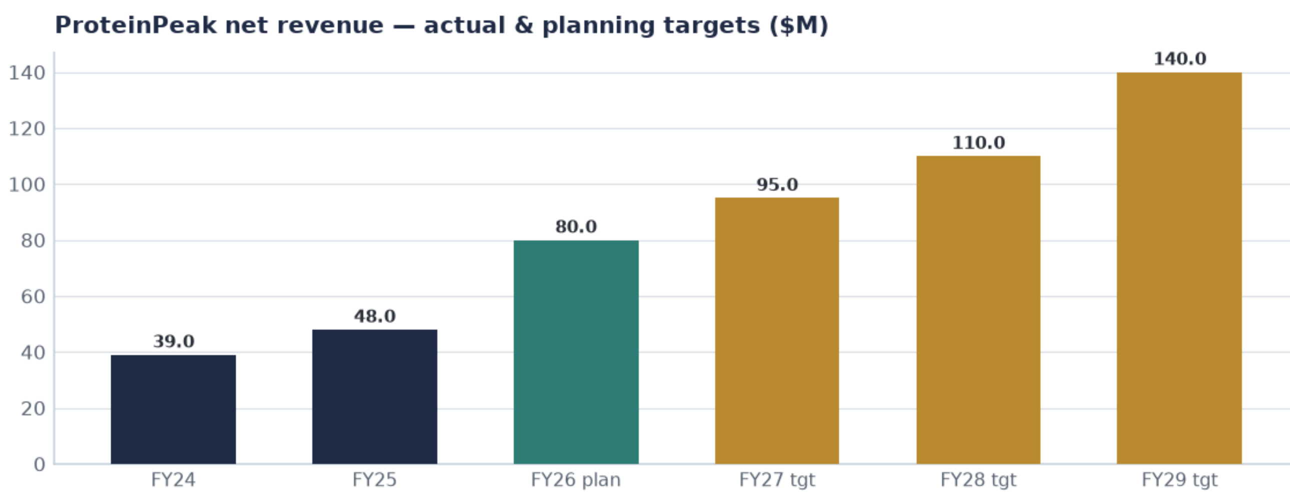


Share climbing through the launch. seed_category_market_size, Wellness Protein, US National (Q2-FY26 is month-to-date).

Source: seed_category_market_size (NielsenIQ Total US xAOC), Wellness Protein; seed_macro_trends MT001 (high-protein cereal 0.92).

2 · The three-year revenue roadmap

ProteinPeak more than doubled from FY24 to the FY26 plan on the strength of the launch build. FY25 closed at $48M; the FY26 plan is $80M, loaded onto PP005 + PP006 shipping from April 20. The roadmap extends to planning targets of ~$110M in FY28 and ~$140M in FY29 — **these FY27–FY29 figures are planning targets, not booked demand** — carried by distribution build-out (Target-first, then Kroger/Walmart), the Chocolate Almond Q3 addition, and a form-factor pipeline.



Navy = actual; teal = FY26 plan; gold = FY27–FY29 planning targets. FY24 $39M / FY25 $48M are actuals (skus.csv, +24.6% YoY); FY26 $80M is plan; FY27+ are planning targets.

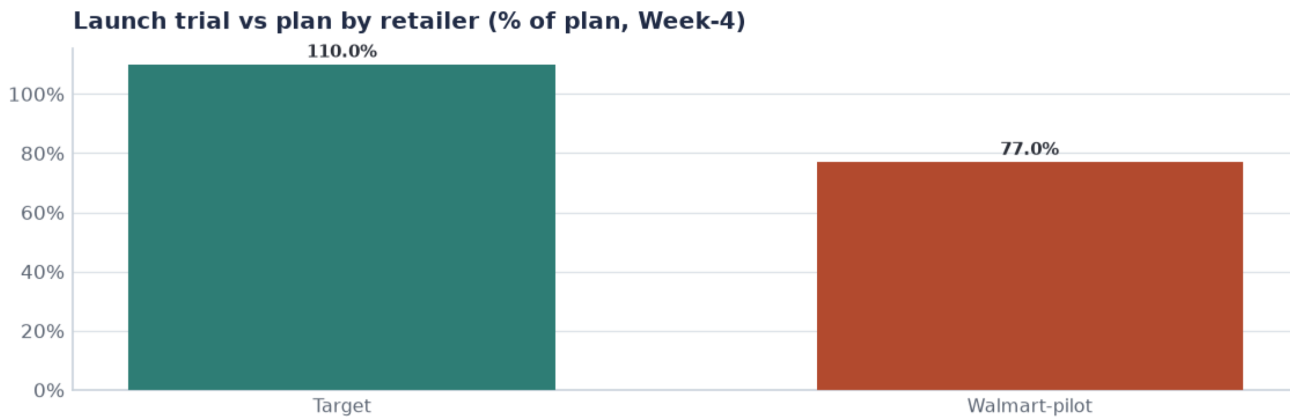
Read the colors literally

FY24–FY25 ($39M → $48M, +24.6% YoY) are measured actuals. FY26 ($80M) is the committed plan. FY27 (~$95M), FY28 (~$110M) and FY29 (~$140M) are planning targets that assume distribution build-out, Chocolate Almond, and the form-factor pipeline all land — they are a roadmap to steer against, not a forecast to bank.

3 · Launch read — strong at Target, soft at Walmart-pilot

3.1 · Trial vs plan by retailer

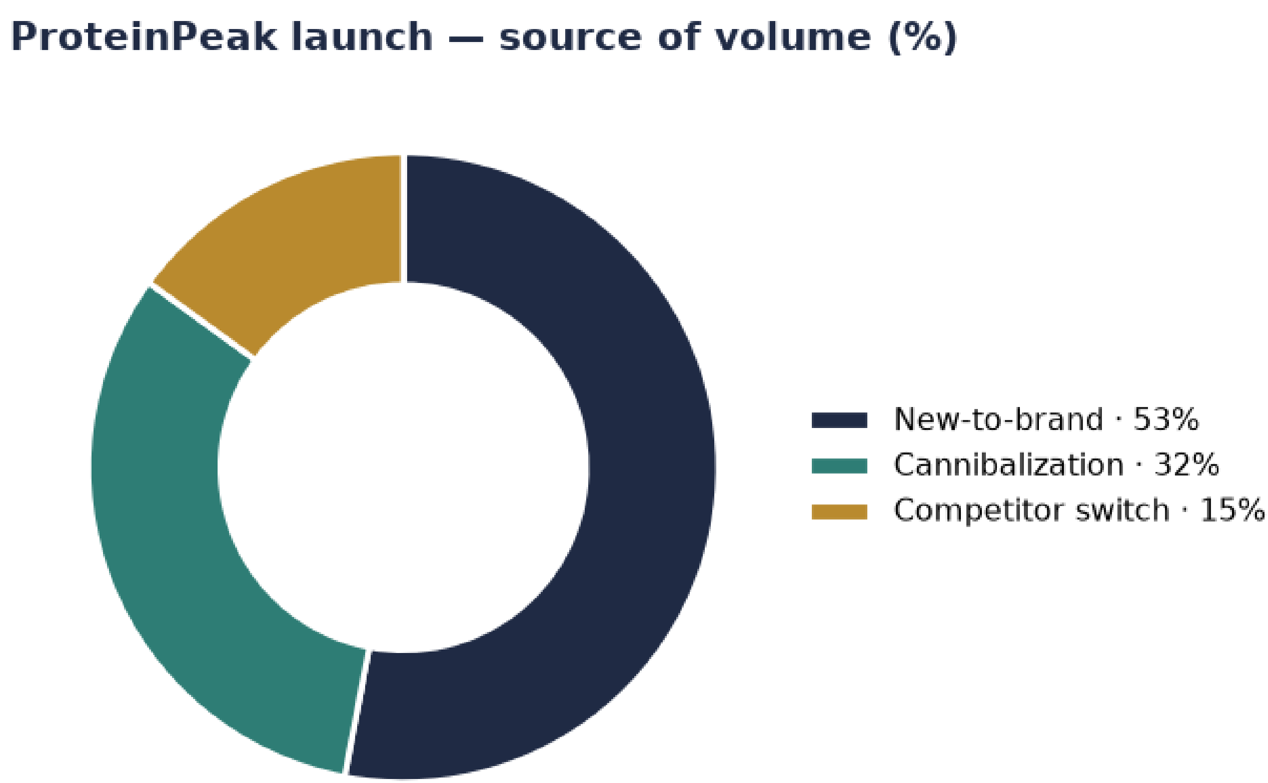
The April 20 launch read splits cleanly by retailer. At Target — where the endcap and Roundel media ran and where Acme over-indexes — trial hit 110–113% of plan and velocity ~17.5 units/store/week. The Walmart pilot ran soft at 77–78% of plan (~9.2 u/store/wk). This is a distribution-and-context story, not a demand story: Acme's Wellness Protein share is 18.4% at Target versus 5.2% at Walmart, so Target is both the stronger launchpad and the more representative read of true demand.



Target clears plan; the Walmart pilot runs soft. proteinpeak_q2_launch + seed_category_market_size (Target/Walmart Wellness Protein share).

3.2 · Source of volume — the launch is additive

Of the households ProteinPeak pulled in, 53% were new-to-brand, 32% cannibalized existing ProteinPeak SKUs, and 15% switched from a competitor. A majority-new-to-brand mix is the signal a healthy launch should send: the brand is growing the franchise, not just reshuffling its own shelf. Week-2 repeat runs ~1.2x the Berry Crunch (PP003) benchmark and social sentiment is +0.44 on ~496 mentions — the strongest sentiment in the Acme portfolio.



Majority new-to-brand — the launch is expanding the franchise. household_transactions (PP005/PP006), of qualified switches.

Source: proteinpeak_q2_launch, household_transactions (PP005/PP006), social_mentions (2026).

4 · Innovation pipeline — gated, sequenced, form-factor led

The pipeline is disciplined: one validated near-term add (Chocolate Almond, Q3), then two form-factor extensions that widen the occasion base. Chocolate Almond cleared its gate — 64% top-two-box against the 55% action standard (+11pp vs the innovation benchmark), with only 8pp substitutional cannibalization against the 12pp SteerCo threshold, so it passes on both purchase intent and additivity (concept_tests). Chocolate as a breakfast flavor over-indexes +14pp among protein-curious shoppers, the exact cohort ProteinPeak is recruiting.

4.1 · ProteinPeak pipeline

Concept	Stage / status	Planned	Yr-1 (est.)	Read
Chocolate Almond (Q3)	Concept-test gate passed	2026-Q3	—	64% top-2-box
Mini Cups Six-Pack	Stage-2 Concept	2027-Q4	$3.4M	conf 0.41
Bars - 12g protein	Stage-1 Idea	2028-Q2	$8.0M	conf 0.28

Source: seeds/innovation_pipeline.csv (ProteinPeak); seed_concept_test_chocolate_almond (Chocolate Almond gate). Yr-1 = planning estimate.

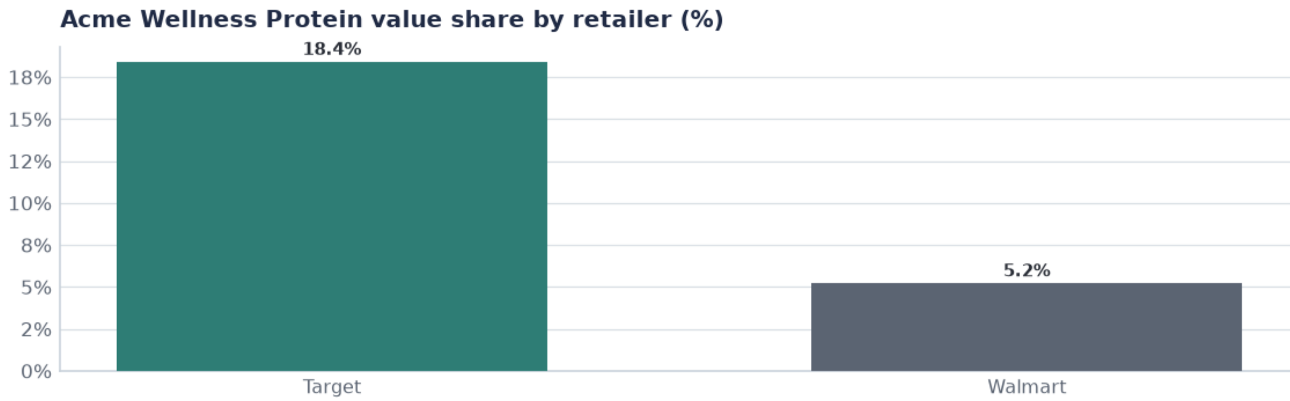
Chocolate Almond passes the gate — advance to Q3 launch

n=1,000; 64% top-two-box clears the 55% action standard (+6pp vs launch-SKU pretest, +11pp vs the 5-year innovation benchmark). Protein-curious cohort 71% top-two-box. Cannibalization vs ProteinPeak launch SKUs is 8pp substitutional — under the 12pp SteerCo gate — and only 2pp vs Crunchwell. Field of Jun 22–Jul 11. See the concept-test read, Report 33.

5 · Where to win — and what to defend against

5.1 · Target-first, channels-out

Target is the anchor. Acme's Wellness Protein value share is 18.4% at Target versus 5.2% at Walmart, and the launch read confirms it converts there. The FY27 distribution plan is Target-first (protect and expand the endcap and everyday facings), then a disciplined Kroger build (Cocoa Almond new-item TPR is already live), then a re-scoped Walmart re-entry once the pilot learnings are worked in. The Target Joint Business Plan, Report 37, carries the account-level detail; this plan sets the brand priority behind it.



Target over-indexes 3.5x on Wellness Protein share. seed_category_market_size, Q2-FY26 MTD.

5.2 · The competitive threat — Field & Honey 14g

Field & Honey 14g protein narrows our headline claim

Larksfield launched Field & Honey Protein 14g (LCH00032) on May 12, 2026, at $4.79/12oz — narrowing ProteinPeak's protein delta from 11g to 6g. A trademark on 'Field & Honey Chocolate Crunch' was filed April 22, signalling a likely Q4 chocolate entry. The defense is not a grams arms-race: ProteinPeak wins on the sugar leg (8g), real-cinnamon taste, +0.44 sentiment, and W2 repeat. Land Chocolate Almond in Q3 to occupy the chocolate-protein space before Larksfield does.

6 · Risks & the FY27–FY29 ask

Watch-items across the roadmap

(1) Walmart-pilot execution gap must close before Walmart scale is committed. (2) Field & Honey 14g (and a likely Q4 chocolate) pressures the claim and the chocolate whitespace simultaneously. (3) The FY27–FY29 targets assume the pipeline lands on cadence — slippage on Chocolate Almond or Mini Cups pulls the curve down. (4) Cannibalization discipline: hold new-SKU substitutional overlap under the 12pp SteerCo gate as the line extends.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Advance Chocolate Almond to a Q3 FY26 launch on the passed gate; occupy chocolate-protein before Field & Honey's likely Q4 entry.	Sage Park	Q3 FY26

#	Action	Owner	When
2	Run the Target-first distribution plan; protect endcap + everyday facings and expand ahead of the FY27 build (see Target JBP, Report 37).	Sage Park / NAM	FY27 H1
3	Close the Walmart-pilot execution gap before committing Walmart scale; re-scope on pilot learnings.	Sage Park / Tom Reilly (NAM)	FY27 H1
4	Sequence the form-factor pipeline: Mini Cups Six-Pack (2027-Q4), Bars 12g (2028) — gate each on concept test and <12pp substitutional overlap.	Sage Park / Lillian Park	FY27–FY28
5	Defend the claim on sugar/taste/repeat, not grams; hold the FY26 $80M and steer FY27–FY29 targets (~$95M / ~$110M / ~$140M) as the pipeline lands.	Sage Park / Finance	FY27 plan